

Oakwood Educational Academy

Parent Handbook 2024-25

Maple Drive, Exeter, Devon, EX4 2RN

Tel: 01392 555 0123

Email: office@oakwood.sch.uk

Website: www.oakwood.sch.uk

Welcome from the Headteacher

Dear Parents and Carers,

Welcome to Oakwood Educational Academy! Whether your child is just starting with us or continuing their journey through primary school, we are delighted to have you as part of our community.

This handbook contains essential information about our school policies, procedures, and day-to-day operations. Please keep it somewhere handy and refer to it throughout the year. If you have any questions that aren't answered here, our office team is always happy to help.

We look forward to working in partnership with you to ensure your child has a happy, successful year at Oakwood.

Warm regards,

Mrs. Sarah Mitchell
Headteacher

School Day Timings

Morning:

- Gates open: 8:40am
- Registration: 8:50am
- School starts: 9:00am (children arriving after this time are marked late)

Break Times:

- Morning break: 10:30am - 10:45am
- Lunch: Reception/KS1: 12:00pm - 1:00pm; KS2: 12:30pm - 1:30pm

Afternoon:

- End of school day: 3:15pm
- After-school club collections: 4:30pm or 5:30pm (depending on booking)

Please ensure your child arrives on time. Persistent lateness disrupts learning for the whole class and is recorded on your child's attendance record.

Attendance and Absence

Reporting Absence

If your child is unable to attend school, you must notify us before 9:00am on each day of absence.

Methods to report absence:

- Telephone: 01392 555 0123 (press 1 for absence line)
- Email: attendance@oakwood.sch.uk

Please provide: Your child's full name and class, reason for absence, and expected return date.

Authorised vs Unauthorised Absence

Authorised absences include: Illness, medical/dental appointments (please try to book outside school hours where possible), religious observance, and exceptional family circumstances (approved in advance).

Unauthorised absences include: Holidays during term time, shopping trips or family days out, looking after siblings or other family members, and birthdays.

Holiday Requests

The Department for Education has made it clear that headteachers may not grant any leave of absence during term time unless there are exceptional circumstances.

We strongly discourage term-time holidays. Fines may be issued by the Local Authority for unauthorised absence.

School Uniform

All children are expected to wear school uniform every day. This helps create a sense of belonging and pride in our school.

Standard Uniform

- **Jumper/Cardigan:** Navy blue with Oakwood logo
- **Shirt:** White polo shirt (with or without logo)
- **Trousers/Skirt/Pinafore:** Grey
- **Shoes:** Black school shoes (not trainers, except on PE days)
- **Coat:** Sensible coat appropriate for the weather

PE Kit

- White t-shirt
- Navy blue shorts
- Trainers (for outdoor PE)
- Plimsolls (for indoor PE)

Children should come to school in their PE kit on their designated PE days - they will not need to change at school.

Additional Notes

- **Jewellery:** Stud earrings only. Watches are allowed. All jewellery must be removed for PE.
- **Hair:** Long hair should be tied back. Extreme hairstyles or unnatural hair colours are not permitted.
- **Nail varnish:** Not permitted.

Lost Property: Please label all items of clothing and belongings. Unnamed lost property is kept for one term then donated to charity.

Physical Education

PE is an important part of the curriculum. All children must participate unless they have a written note from a parent/carer or doctor.

PE Kit

All children should come to school in PE kit on their designated PE days. PE kit consists of: White t-shirt, navy shorts, and trainers.

During winter months (November-February), children should also bring: Tracksuit bottoms or leggings, and a warm top (navy or black hoodie/sweatshirt).

PE Days by Year Group

Year Group	PE Days
Reception	Wednesday afternoons
Year 1	Monday and Thursday
Year 2	Tuesday and Friday
Year 3	Monday and Wednesday
Year 4	Tuesday and Thursday
Year 5	Wednesday and Friday
Year 6	Monday and Friday

Please ensure your child has appropriate footwear and outdoor clothing for outdoor PE sessions during colder months.

Jewellery must be removed for PE for safety reasons. If your child has recently had their ears pierced and cannot remove earrings, they must sit out of PE until the earrings can be removed.

Illness and Medical Matters

When to Keep Your Child at Home

Please do not send your child to school if they:

- Have a temperature of 38°C or above
- Have been sick or had diarrhoea in the last 48 hours
- Have an infectious disease
- Are unwell enough that they cannot participate in normal school activities

48-Hour Rule

If your child has been sick or had diarrhoea, they must stay at home for 48 hours after the last episode. This helps prevent the spread of infection to other children and staff.

Infectious Diseases

Illness	Exclusion Period
Chickenpox	Until all blisters have crusted over (usually 5 days)
Impetigo	Until lesions are crusted and healed, or 48 hours after starting antibiotics
Scarlet Fever	24 hours after starting antibiotics
Slapped Cheek	None (once rash appears, no longer infectious)
Hand, Foot and Mouth	Until feeling better and temperature has resolved
Conjunctivitis	None, but see GP if severe

Head Lice: Children with head lice do not need to be excluded from school. Please treat at home and notify the school office so we can alert other parents (anonymously).

Medication at School

We can only administer prescribed medication that needs to be taken during the school day. You must complete a **Medication Consent Form** (available from the office) before any medication can be given.

We cannot administer paracetamol or other non-prescribed medication unless there is a specific care plan in place (e.g., for chronic conditions).

School Meals and Break Time Snacks

Hot School Meals

Hot meals are provided daily and must be ordered via **ParentPay** by **Wednesday each week** for the following week.

The cost is **£2.50 per meal** (KS2 only - Reception, Year 1 and Year 2 receive free school meals under the Universal Infant Free School Meals scheme).

Packed Lunches

If your child brings a packed lunch, please ensure it is healthy and balanced.

Please do not include: Nuts or products containing nuts, glass bottles, fizzy drinks or energy drinks, excessive sweets or chocolate bars.

Safeguarding

The safety and wellbeing of every child is our top priority.

All staff at Oakwood are trained in safeguarding and child protection. If you have any concerns about a child's safety or welfare, please speak to:

Mrs. Jane Henderson - Deputy Head and Designated Safeguarding Lead

Mrs. Sarah Mitchell - Headteacher (Deputy DSL)

You can contact them via the school office or email: safeguarding@oakwood.sch.uk

Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND)

We are committed to ensuring that all children, including those with special educational needs or disabilities, receive the support they need to thrive.

Mr. David Chen is our Special Educational Needs Coordinator (SENCO) and is available to discuss any concerns you may have about your child's learning or development.

School Staff 2024-25

Leadership Team

- Mrs. Sarah Mitchell - Headteacher
- Mrs. Jane Henderson - Deputy Head & DSL
- Mr. David Chen - Assistant Head & SENCO

Teaching Staff by Year Group

- **Reception:** Miss Emma Thompson, Mrs. Rachel Kumar
- **Year 1:** Mrs. Lisa Andrews, Mr. James Wilson
- **Year 2:** Miss Sophie Baker, Mrs. Catherine Moore
- **Year 3:** Miss Priya Patel, Mr. Robert Taylor
- **Year 4:** Mrs. Helen Grant, Miss Amy Richardson
- **Year 5:** Mr. Thomas Clarke, Mrs. Jennifer Scott
- **Year 6:** Mr. Michael Stevens, Mrs. Susan Wright

Support Staff

- **School Office:** Mrs. Patricia Davies (Office Manager), Miss Kelly Brooks
- **Caretaker:** Mr. Alan Johnson
- **Teaching Assistants:** 8 TAs across year groups

Communication and Contact

School Office Hours

The school office is open Monday to Friday: 8:30am - 4:00pm during term time.

How to Contact Us

- **General enquiries:** office@oakwood.sch.uk or 01392 555 0123
- **Absence reporting:** attendance@oakwood.sch.uk or 01392 555 0123 (press 1)
- **Safeguarding concerns:** safeguarding@oakwood.sch.uk
- **SENCO:** senco@oakwood.sch.uk

Term Dates 2024-25

Autumn Term 2024

- First day: Wednesday 4th September 2024
- Half-term: Monday 28th October - Friday 1st November 2024
- Last day: Friday 20th December 2024 (1:30pm finish)

Spring Term 2025

- First day: Monday 6th January 2025
- Half-term: Monday 17th February - Friday 21st February 2025
- Last day: Friday 4th April 2025

Summer Term 2025

- First day: Tuesday 22nd April 2025
- May Day (school closed): Monday 5th May 2025
- Half-term: Monday 26th May - Friday 30th May 2025
- Last day: Wednesday 23rd July 2025

INSET Days (school closed to pupils)

Monday 2nd September 2024, Tuesday 3rd September 2024, Monday 25th November 2024, Friday 14th February 2025, Thursday 24th July 2025

Thank You

Thank you for taking the time to read this handbook. We hope it answers most of your questions, but please don't hesitate to contact us if you need any further information.

We look forward to a wonderful year ahead!

Oakwood Educational Academy

Growing Together, Learning Forever